Winston Abernethy-Cole

Senior Systems Administrator

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SUMMARY

Systems administrator with eighteen years looking after Windows and Linux servers for mid-sized organisations. Reliable, calm during outages and thorough with documentation. I prefer well-tested backups over clever tricks. Outside work I coach a youth football team and restore old radios, which probably explains my patience with legacy hardware. I mentor apprentices and enjoy sharing practical lessons from years of keeping services running.

SKILLS

Windows Server	Active Directory	Group Policy
VMware vSphere	Veeam	Exchange
Red Hat Linux	PowerShell	Cisco switching
Nagios	DNS and DHCP	

EXPERIENCE

Period	Position	Responsibilities
2014 – Present	**Senior Systems Administrator** Pennine Building Society	• Run 140 virtual servers on VMware with replication to a secondary site; tested recovery twice a year. • Administer Active Directory, Group Policy and Exchange for 1,100 staff. • Lead patching cycles and maintain a change calendar approved by the service desk. • Replaced tape backups with Veeam, shortening restore times from hours to minutes. • Documented every system in a configuration database, including owners, dependencies and recovery priorities. • Migrated mailboxes from on-premises Exchange to a hosted mail service over four weekends with no lost messages. • Chair the monthly change meeting, review risks and rollback plans, and keep the business informed of planned outages. • Negotiate hardware and support renewals with suppliers and maintain a lifecycle plan covering servers, storage and network.
2008 – 2014	**Systems Administrator** Aire Engineering Group	• Maintained file servers, print servers and Linux web servers. • Managed firewall rules and VPN access for remote workers. • Built a patching schedule that reduced the number of emergency fixes by around a third. • Introduced a clear asset register and hardware refresh plan. • Ran disaster recovery tests with business owners and documented the lessons learned for management.
2006 – 2008	**IT Technician** Calder Office Supplies	• Desktop support and hardware repairs for 80 users. • Learned the foundations of support, including hardware, networks and printers.

EDUCATION

2004 – 2006	HND Computing	Leeds Northern College

LANGUAGES

English (native)

CERTIFICATIONS

- MCSA Windows Server 2016
- VMware Certified Professional